probability for getting the nation into the wars one prefers we enter, and keeping us out of the wars he prefers we avoid? Obviously, Americans differ on this issue, some favoring World War II, Korea, and Vietnam alike, some wishing we had stayed out of all three, and many drawing distinctions among them.

It is well to recall that in 1812, and again in 1898, Congress rather than the President took the lead in forcing war upon the country. Indeed, the Spanish-American War might have been fought five years earlier had not President Cleveland made plain that he would not wage it even if Congress declared it.

Second, however one answers the first question "on the average," what about the next case, say in Southeast Asia or the Middle East? Under each proposed realignment of power, what are the prospects for "appropriate" choice? Again, there is obvious disagreement among Americans on what may be appropriate.

Third, how does each proposal fare as a mechanism for resolving differences among Americans over the decision to enter war? What are its prospects for producing politically viable decisions about war? Is the process one that most citizens recognize as legitimate for making such important decisions about issues on which the nation may be sharply divided?

Fourth, how will each proposed realignment affect the personal power of particular individuals now on the Washington scene? For those involved in making choices about these proposals, the importance of this consideration is clear. For those of us who watch from a distance, the effect of realignments on the influence of our political champions—and their opponents—is important.

Fifth, what is the likelihood of action on each proposal? At any given time, what seem to be prevailing attitudes in press and public? How strongly are these shared by whom in Congress? Where are they placed on which committes in which house? Who else is to be reached, by whom, and how? Legislation calls for successive majorities starting with subcommittees. Short of a tidal wave of public sentiment, one cannot count on legislative action without counting heads.

Finally, what of unintended side effects? These are the bane of constitutional reforms adopted to keep some contemporary problem from ever occurring again. The Twentieth Amendment is a classic case. In order to avoid, forevermore, the crisis that ensued in the four months from FDR's election to inaugural, we so shortened the learning time for Presidents-elect as to invite fiascos like the Bay of Pigs.